PERFORMANCE

The Redmi Note 17 Pro Max comes powered with the 4nm fabricated Qualcomm's Snapdragon 6 Gen 5 chipset. The device also comes in two variants- 8 GB + 256 GB and 12 GB + 256 GB, and both come with LPDDR5X RAM and UFS 4.1 storage. While this is a newly launched processor and can easily handle your daily tasks- scrolling, multi-tasking, streaming and much more, I expected better. Competitors like the OnePlus Nord 6, Oppo K13 Turbo are offering a Snapdragon 8 series chipset that is way better at a similar price.

Speaking of the numbers, Antutu returned a score of 995983. Geekbench recorded 960 in the single-core and 3002 in the multi-core. The 3DMark Wildlife Extreme test gave an overall score of 1165.

However, in an exclusive interview with Digit, Xiaomi said it is not chasing benchmark numbers or specifications for the sake of it. Instead, the company says its focus is on delivering a better overall user experience, particularly at a challenging time for the smartphone industry. And to be honest, that shows. The device held 76% of its peak performance under sustained load.

If you are a gamer, the Redmi Note 17 Pro Max will offer decent experience. Both BGMI and CoD Mobile ran up to 90fps without any major frame drops and the thermals did not become a problem even during extended sessions.





Coming to software, it runs on HyperOS 3 based on Android 16, and if you've used a recent Xiaomi, Redmi or Poco device, the interface will feel familiar. There's a good amount of customisation on offer, especially around the lock screen. At the same time, you get bloatware in the UI but that can be uninstalled. Redmi is promising four years of OS updates and six years of security patches.

VERDICT

The Redmi Note 17 Pro Max is a phone that gets the basics right, but it is also clear that Xiaomi has picked its priorities. The 10,000mAh battery is the biggest highlight here, and the excellent battery life, fast charging, bright display and strong durability make it a compelling everyday phone. Performance is capable for regular use and casual gaming, although the chipset feels less impressive when you consider what some competitors offer. The camera setup is another area where I expected more, especially after the 200MP sensor on the previous generation and the absence of a telephoto camera.

The company has focused on delivering a phone that can last for days, survive more heavy loads and offer a consistent everyday experience. The Redmi Note 17 Pro Max is a good proposition for someone who prioritises battery life, durability and a good display. Those looking for the best cameras or performance will have to look elsewhere.

– Siddharth Malhotra



SPECIFICATIONS

Processor: Snapdragon 6 Gen 5 | Memory: 8/12 GB LPDDR5X | Storage: 256 GB UFS 4.1 | Display: 6.83-inch 1.5K AMOLED | Refresh rate: 120 Hz | Brightness: 3500 nits | Camera (Rear): 50MP + 8MP | Camera(Front): 32MP | Battery: 10,000 mAh | Charging: 100W Wired, 27W Wired reverse charging | OS: Xiaomi HyperOS 3 - Android 16

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